Aiden Palladino

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Education

University of South Florida Tampa, FL
B.S. in Cybersecurity, Bellini College of Artificial Intelligence, Cybersecurity, and Computing *Expected December 2027*
Dean's List: Fall 2025, Spring 2026. GPA: 3.82/4.00
Relevant Coursework: Information Security & IT Risk Management, Penetration Testing, Computer & Information Networks, Cloud Computing, Hands-On Cybersecurity, Data Structures & Algorithms, Intro to Databases, OOP
Certifications: CompTIA Security+ (in progress, expected December 2026)

Projects

AWS Cloud Labs (AWS Academy)
- Built a VPC with public and private subnets across two Availability Zones, with an EC2 web server allowing only web traffic
- Built a serverless API using API Gateway, Lambda, and DynamoDB to serve data to a website hosted on S3
- Assigned IAM users to groups with least-privilege policies and tested that each user could only do their role's tasks

USF Hack The Box Capture the Flag
- Solved 7 challenges in web exploitation, reverse engineering, forensics, and ICS on a 3-person team

Suricata IDS Lab
- Set up Suricata on Kali Linux to analyze my own captured ping and Nmap traffic
- Wrote a custom rule to detect pings and separated real alerts from false positives

Hand-Tracking Robot
- Served as Hardware Lead on a team project to build a robot that detects and follows a hand
- Programmed its movement in C++ using an ultrasonic sensor to track the hand
- 3D printed the robot's outer shell and assembled all of its hardware components

Hack The Box Labs
- Completed 20+ HTB Academy modules and 5+ machines focused on web exploitation and enumeration
- Used SQL injection, command injection, and Metasploit to gain access to practice targets

Experience

ReliaQuest Tampa, FL
Security Operations Labs Participant *October 2026 – Present*
- Investigate security events hands-on in ReliaQuest's GreyMatter platform, including a CTF built inside GreyMatter
- Analyze firewall, proxy, IDS/IPS, and Microsoft 365 sign-in logs from vendors like Palo Alto, Check Point, and Cisco
- Research suspicious domains and file hashes with WHOIS and VirusTotal, and map incident scenarios to the attack lifecycle

True Food Kitchen Tampa, FL
Busser *May 2026 – Present*
- Support service for 100+ guests per shift, coordinating with servers and kitchen staff to keep tables turning at peak hours

Chick-fil-A Valrico, FL
Team Member *June 2023 – July 2024*
- Delivered fast, friendly customer service and handled cash at a high-volume location averaging $20,000 in daily sales

Activities & Leadership

Delta Tau Delta Fraternity August 2024 – Present
Finance Chair, Secretary Assistant, Social Chair
- Tracked chapter budgets and expenses, maintained chapter records, and planned events for a 100-member chapter

Whitehatters Computer Security Club, USF August 2026 – Present
Member
- Participate in club meetings, tool demos, and hands-on security practice sessions to sharpen skills outside of class
- Explored topics including SQL injection, cross-site scripting (XSS), Active Directory attacks, and LLM security

Skills

Security Tools: GreyMatter, Nmap, Metasploit, Wireshark, Suricata, Hashcat, sqlmap, Kali Linux, Windows Event Viewer
Security Practices: Log analysis, intrusion detection, OSINT, MITRE ATT&CK, STIX
Cloud & Systems: AWS (EC2, VPC, IAM, S3, Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB), Linux, Windows, VMware
Programming: Python, C, C++, SQL